

There are a few crucial steps that you need to follow along with important points to remember to make things easier in the process.

Planning the custom loop

You probably got interested into build your own custom loop after looking at the insane hardline liquid cooling builds out there. And you might have imagined multiple custom loop designs of your own inside your head. All those designs need to be put on paper in the form of sketches so that you can plan better. If you've already bought a case, then your design should be compatible with the interiors of the case. With this template in mind, you have to think of the parts that your build requires. EKWB's CLC (Custom Loop Configurator) is a great tool to figure out what kind of parts you will need for your build. It lets you pick your components and what level of loop you want to create. Based on that, it will generate a list of parts for you. It's up to you whether you want to buy the parts from them or you could simply look towards other manufacturers for the same parts. However, this is a really powerful tool that you should definitely use while planning your custom loop build. You can check it out here: <https://dgit.in/EKCLC>.

After your parts have been finalised, there are several things you need to figure out. You have to decide the location of your radiator, whether it you want to install it on the front or top panel. You'll need to think of the location for your reservoir and pump. Then, you will need to figure out the route of the loop between the components. If you're using soft tubing, they would make direct connections without worrying about bends. However, you will have to plan the tubing so as to not cause problems to the other components inside. The soft tubing connections shouldn't be tight and there should always be some slack between the two connections. This will ensure that the tubing doesn't come out from the fittings or have a loose fit. In hard tubing, things are a little different since you have to bend the tubes according to the space available. For aesthetic purposes, you can plan long routes by using longer tubes with more bends. But that will only add to the cost of tubing and shorter length loops will always have the best flow of fluid.

As for the order of the flow and route of the loop, it won't matter much since the fluid will be uniformly cooled anyway. However, if you want to follow a conventional route, then the flow should start from the pump to the water blocks to the radiator and back to the reservoir. We'll be talking more about this when the tubing is being prepared. With everything planned, it's time to buy and start working on your build. Before you begin, you have to